

Document 1: Michael Phelps - The Most Decorated Olympian

Michael Phelps, an American swimmer, is the most decorated Olympian in history with a total of 28 Olympic medals, including 23 golds. He made history at the 2008 Beijing Olympics by winning 8 gold medals, breaking the previous record of 7 golds held by Mark Spitz. Phelps first competed in the Olympics at age 15 during the Sydney 2000 Games, finishing fifth in the 200m butterfly. Over his career, he won 6 gold and 2 bronze medals at Athens 2004, 8 golds at Beijing 2008, 4 golds and 2 silvers at London 2012, and 5 golds and 1 silver at Rio 2016. His dominance in swimming and numerous world records have made him a global sports icon.